EU FUNDING POLICY CLINIC

Find your lab's step on the road to 2028

Carlos Alcobia
Buinho Creative Hub · Messejana, Alentejo (PT)

Vulca Seminar 2026
Cuenca · November 2026

WHO WE ARE

A rural fablab and artist residency

WHERE

Messejana, Baixo Alentejo, Portugal

SINCE

2015



TWO ORGANISATIONS

Buinho Associação · non-profit

Zingarelho Lda · education company

WHERE WE POSITION OURSELVES

Small, Local, Open, Connected

S

Small
A village lab

L

Local
Rooted in its territory

O

Open
Open tools, open doors

C

Connected
Europe as our network

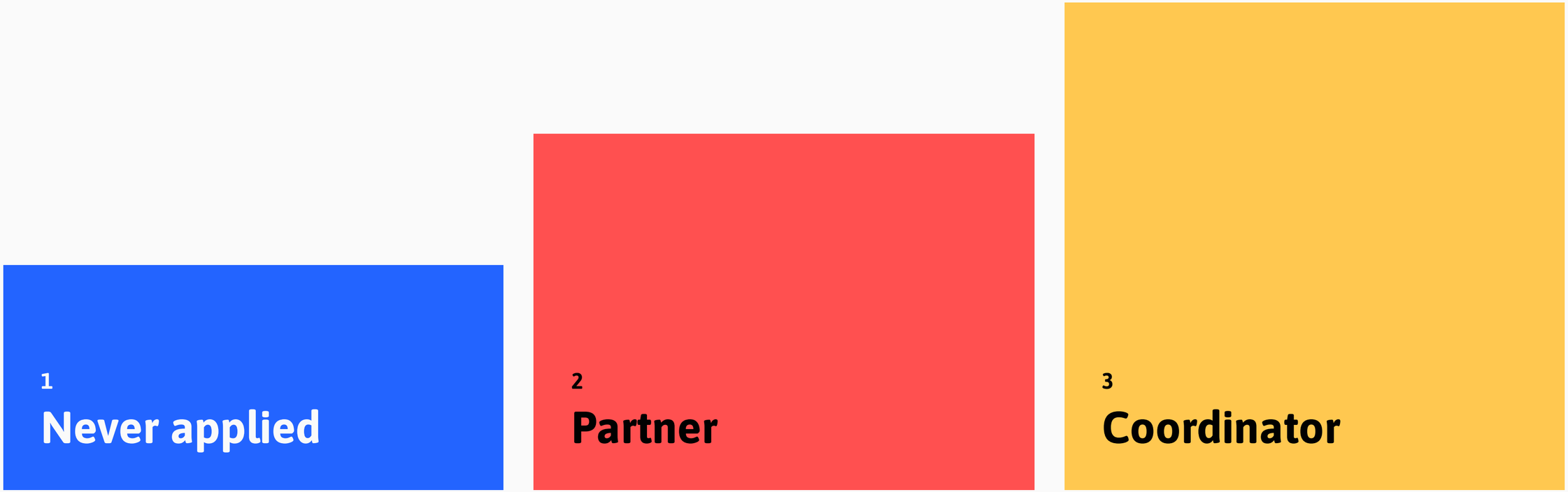
Ezio Manzini · the SLOC scenario

THE QUESTION OF THIS SESSION

EU projects — for which organisational strategy?

WHO IS IN THE ROOM

Three starting points



No stage is better. Each asks for different steps.

THE NEXT HOUR AND A HALF

How this session works

1	Our arc, 2016–2028	18 min
2	How we design a project	10 min
3	What exists today	7 min
4	Around the corner: 2028–2034	8 min
5	The platform	6 min
6	Your turn: test it, ask	25 min

OUR ARC · 2016–2028

Ten years, five phases

2016–21
First steps: mobility

- Facing the Street
- Precious Plastic
- Lingua Franca
- Youth Sensing
- Gota d’Água

2019–22
A stable base

- Solidarity Corps Quality Label
- Youth accreditation
- EIRA school consortium

2019–25
First partnerships

- FabLabs in Adult Education
- WeRepair
- EWaste Learning Paths
- EntreYouth

2024–26
Partner in other labs’ projects

- Rural Eco-Clubs
- Future Food Labs
- RE-POWER
- WeRepair Youth
- I Can Touch It

2026–28
New lines, coordination

- Sentir Europa
- Materia Viva
- Sensing Belonging
- ABRI
- Invisible Cartographies
- ESPECTROS

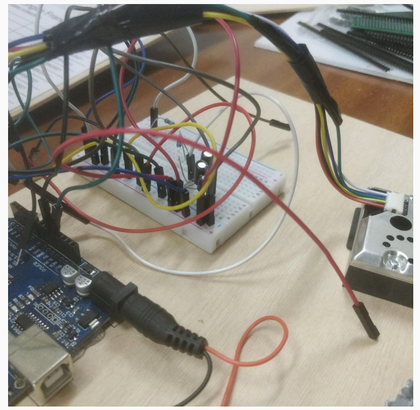
PHASE 1 · 2016–2021

Mobility first: test a method with young people

2016	**Facing the Street**	partner · youth workers · Ljubljana
2018–19	**Precious Plastic**	coordinator · plastic recycling machines
2019–21	**Lingua Franca**	coordinator · biohacking, biomaterials
2020–21	**Youth Sensing**	coordinator · citizen sensing
2020–21	**Gota d'Água**	coordinator · water, sensors, LoRa







PHASE 2 · 2019–2022

A stable base under the projects



SOLIDARITY CORPS

Quality Label

2019, renewed for 2022–27

Volunteers every year since 2022



ERASMUS+ YOUTH

Youth accreditation

2020 call

Trainings and exchanges every year since 2022



ERASMUS+ SCHOOLS

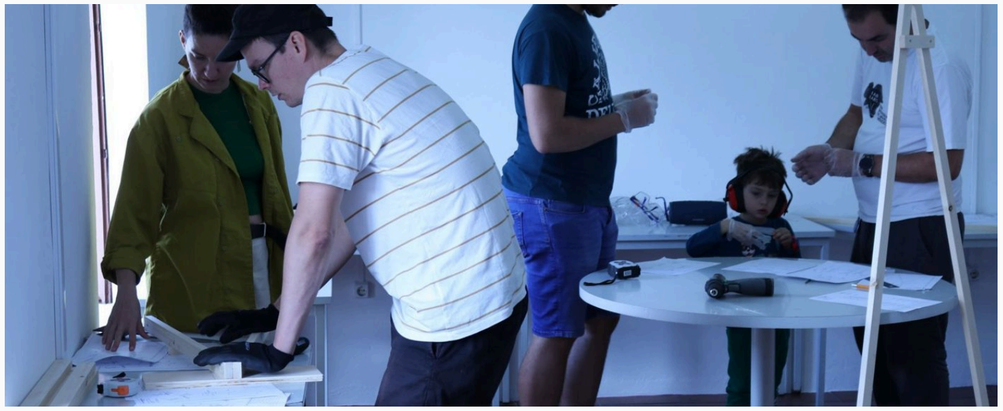
EIRA consortium

2020 call · 7 school clusters

Mobility every year since 2022

PHASE 3 · 2019–2025

From partner to coordinator



KA204 · PARTNER · 2019–22

FabLabs: New Technologies in Adult Education

6 organisations, 5 countries

Our first adult education project

KA210 · COORDINATOR · ONE PER SECTOR

2021–23	**WeRepair** adults · Mountain Makers (FR), FabLab Cuenca (ES) · Vulca associated
2021–23	**EWaste Learning Paths** schools · TransfoLAB BCN (ES), Maltepe Fen Lisesi (TR)
2024–25	**EntreYouth** youth · CoLab House (GR), BDK Bodrum (TR)

Same format, three sectors: small first.

THREAD · REPAIR

One theme becomes a series

2021–23
WeRepair
coordinator

→

2023–
Repair Café marathons
with Resialentejo · award 2024

→

2024–25
Rural Eco-Clubs
partner · EPALE article

→

2025–26
RE-POWER
partner · sewing club

→

2025–26
WeRepair Youth
partner · same consortium

→

2026–27
ABRI
partner · the sewing club











PHASE 4 · 2024–2026

Partner in other labs' projects

KA210 · DE

Rural Eco-Clubs

adults

We led quality and monitoring

KA210 · DE

Future Food Labs

youth

We ran the lab in Portugal

KA210 · IE

RE-POWER

adults

We led the Repair Café activity

KA210 · FR

WeRepair Youth

youth

We lead youth worker training

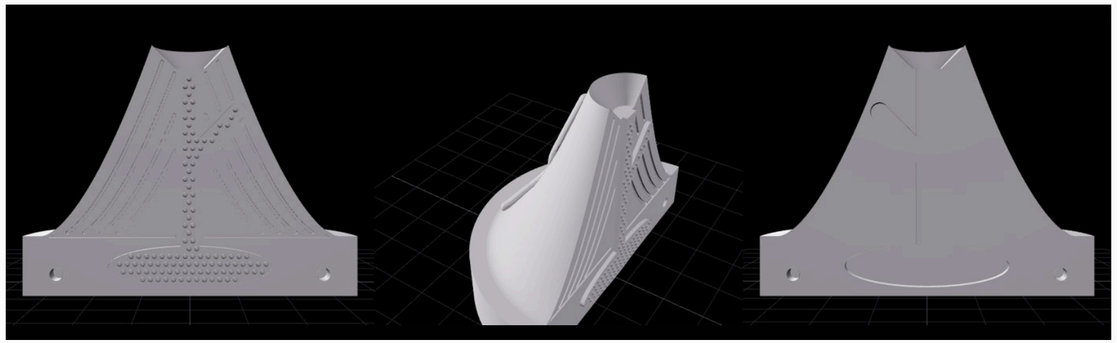
KA220 · SI

I Can Touch It

schools · 2025–27

We are the digital fabrication partner





Lead a real part. Keep something at home.

PHASE 5 · 2026–2027

Four small partnerships, new lines



KA210-YOU · COORDINATOR

Sentir Europa

FabLab Mérida (ES)

citizen sensing

73 → 78



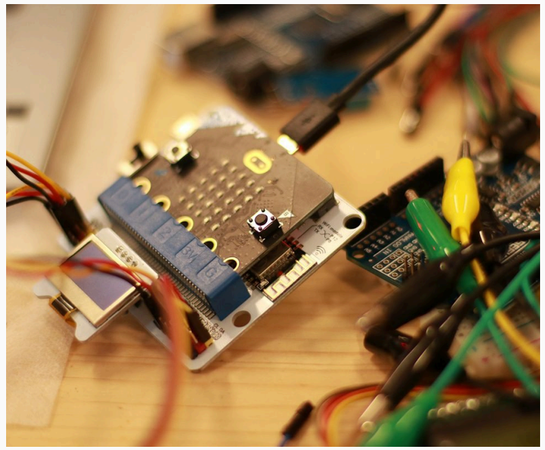
KA210-YOU · PARTNER

Materia Viva

Dà Locu, Corsica (FR)

biofabrication

83, not funded → approved



KA210-SCH · ZINGARELHO

Sensing Belonging

a school in Lahnstein (DE)

sensing in schools



KA210-ADU · PARTNER

ABRI

8 Fablab Drôme (FR)

sewing, fabrication, care

CREATIVE EUROPE

From partner to coordinator in two calls

ERASMUS+ KA220 · 2025–27

I Can Touch It

We meet a school in Belgrade

→

PARTNER · 2026–27

Invisible Cartographies

the Belgrade school coordinates

86

→

COORDINATOR · 2027–28

ESPECTROS

with partners from SI and DE

90

Scores out of 100 · Traces in the Ground (2025): 77, above the threshold, no budget left

ACROSS PROGRAMMES

Four threads, one territory

	MOBILITY	PARTNERSHIPS	CULTURE · NATIONAL
Repair	Precious Plastic · youth worker trainings	WeRepair · Eco-Clubs · RE-POWER · WeRepair Youth · ABRI	—
Citizen sensing	Youth Sensing · Gota d'Água	Sentir Europa · Sensing Belonging	Invisible Cartographies
Biomaterials	Lingua Franca	Materia Viva	SUBSTRACTO (national arts fund)
Inclusive technology	—	I Can Touch It · Sensing Belonging	Invisible Cartographies · ESPECTROS

The ground under all of them: rural people with fewer opportunities.

WHO COMES BACK

Partners return, projects follow

FabLab Cuenca (ES)	WeRepair · Rural Eco-Clubs · WeRepair Youth · Invisible Cartographies
Mountain Makers (FR)	WeRepair · WeRepair Youth
A school in Belgrade (RS)	I Can Touch It · Invisible Cartographies
FabLab Mérida (ES)	youth exchanges · Sentir Europa
Vulca network	associated partner in WeRepair

A new partner enters next to a trusted one.

Mobility tests. Partnerships build. Coordination comes after.

A theme outlives any project.

Partners come from networks and earlier projects.

A rejection is a draft.

ONE STRATEGY ABOVE THE PROJECTS

Three branches, a stable base

Gambiarra

Art, technology, community: residencies, artistic research

Educativo

Digital and creative skills, inclusive education

Transição

Repair, circular economy, community resilience

Base: yearly accreditations + Quality Label

> **The programme adapts to the strategy. Not the reverse.**

HOW WE CHOOSE PRIORITIES

Inclusion first, justified by the territory

SINCE 2025

Inclusion is the main priority in almost every form

- Rural, low-density: name who lives there
- Neurodivergence: a second axis, mixed groups, no diagnosis asked
- Environment enters through making: repair, e-waste, textiles, mycelium
- A frequent trio: inclusion · participation · quality of youth work

From 25 of our own and partner applications, 2021–2026

INSIDE THE FORM

Each objective answers a priority you ticked

Objective

what changes, for whom

→

Selected priority

one of those you ticked

→

Named EU policy

e.g. EU Youth Strategy, Disability Strategy, Digital Education Action Plan

A SLIP WE FOUND IN OUR OWN FORMS

Arguing for a priority we had not selected

CREATIVE EUROPE

Inclusion as authorship, not compensation

- Objective chosen: Innovation
- Neurodivergent artists as authors
- A cultural programme, not a social one
- Partners who cover what we lack: dissemination, artistic depth

ESPECTROS · 2026 CALL

90

27/30	Relevance	**27/30**	Quality
18/20	Management	**18/20**	Dissemination

RESUBMISSIONS

A rejection is a draft

Sentir Europa	73	→	**78**	not funded 2025 · approved 2026
Materia Viva	83	→	**78**	not funded 2025 · approved 2026

Open with the old score and what you changed

Impact: our weakest criterion, every time

THE DETAILS THAT MATTER

Partners, money, paperwork

Partners	Money	Paperwork
A new partner next to a trusted one	Above €60,000: financial capacity can be checked	Lost to paperwork, not quality: a wrong signature, a contract not signed in time
Complementarity, trust, sector	Creative Europe: 20% your own	Fewer, better applications
Which of your organisations applies matters	Grants come in instalments: plan the gap	Make mobilities coincide, own costs only

TODAY · 2021–2027

What exists today

ERASMUS+ KA1
Mobility

KA122 short-term

KA120 / KA121 accreditation

KA152 / KA153 youth exchanges, youth workers

ERASMUS+ KA2
Partnerships

KA210 small-scale · for newcomers

KA220 cooperation

SOLIDARITY CORPS
Volunteering

Hosting European volunteers

CREATIVE EUROPE · CERV
Culture, citizens

Small-scale cooperation min. 3 entities, 3 countries

CERV citizens, equality, rights, values

2026 CALLS

What your organisation receives

KA122 · KA1 accredited	unit costs	**€100–350 per participant, to organise**
KA152 youth exchanges	unit costs	**€125 per participant, to organise**
Solidarity Corps	unit costs per day	**€27 per volunteer per day in PT · Quality Label: no money**
KA210 small-scale	lump sum	**€30,000 or €60,000**
KA220 cooperation	lump sum	**€120,000 · €250,000 · €400,000**
Creative Europe, small scale	co-financing	**up to €200,000, 80% of the budget**
CERV town twinning	lump sum	**about €8,500–51,000, paid at the end**

Four horizontal priorities

Inclusion and diversity

Environment and fight against climate change

Digital transformation

Common values, civic engagement, preparedness and participation

KA210 / KA220 FORM

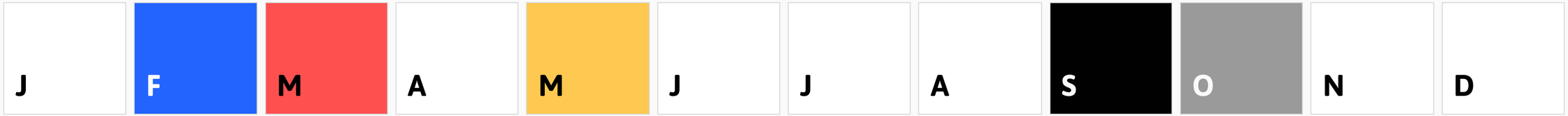
1 main priority
+ up to 2 more
+ up to 3 topics

BUINHO SINCE 2025

Inclusion as main priority, justified by the territory

A TYPICAL YEAR

Deadlines come back every year



- **February** · Mobility, youth, volunteering
- **March** · Partnerships KA210, KA220
- **May** · Creative Europe cooperation
- **September** · Accreditations · CERV town twinning
- **October** · Second rounds, if your agency opens one · Quality Label
- **Summer · November** · Results: partnerships · Creative Europe

Find partners three months before.

Based on the 2026 calls · check each year's call

2027

The last calls under known rules

- 2027 calls: not yet published
- Accreditations valid until 31 Dec 2027

ERASMUS+ 2028–2034 · COMMISSION PROPOSAL, JULY 2025

Pillars, not key actions

KA1 mobility

Solidarity Corps

KA2 partnerships

KA3 policy support

PILLAR I

Learning opportunities for all

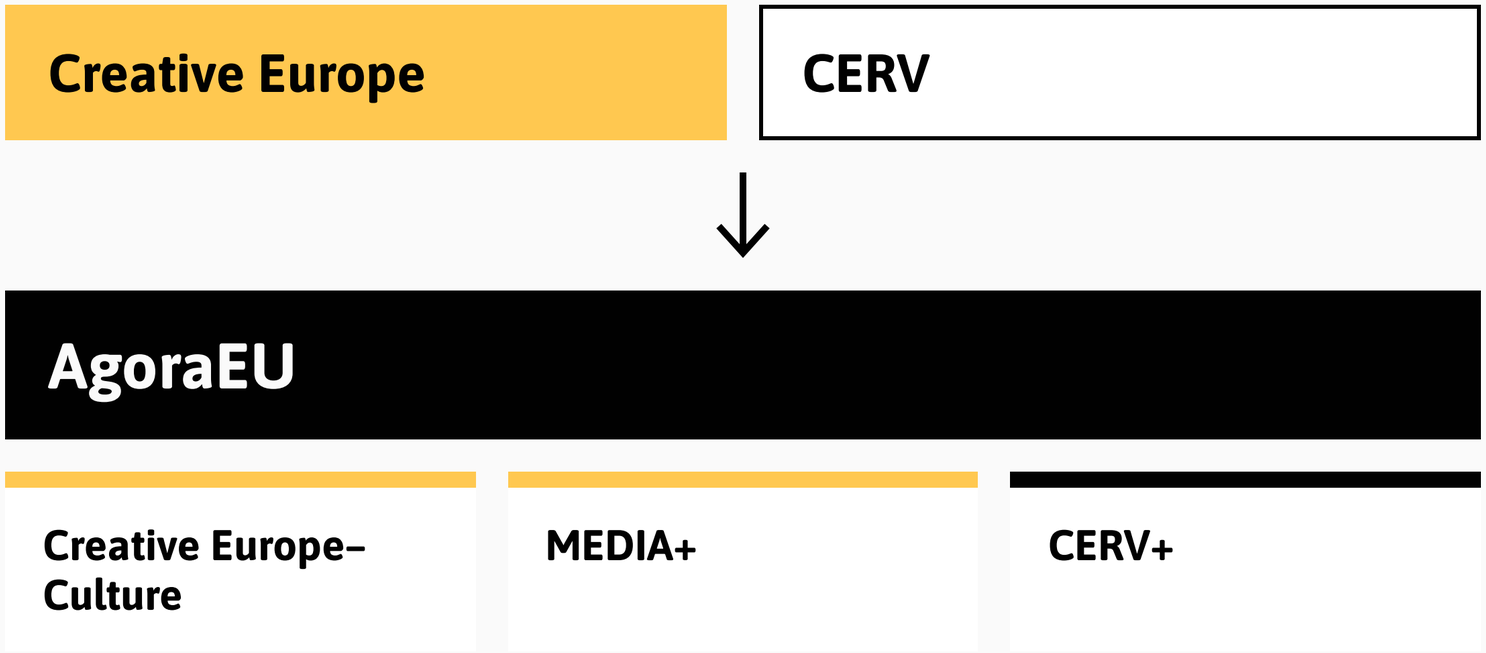
Learning mobility · volunteering

PILLAR II

Capacity building support

Cooperation among organisations · policy support

Culture and citizens together



COM(2025)550 · proposed ~€8.6 bn

STATE OF PLAY · 7 NOVEMBER 2026

Not law yet

COMMISSION

€40.8 bn

PARLIAMENT

€47.39 bn

for Erasmus+ 2028–2034

16 Jul 2025
Commission proposal

11 May 2026
Council partial position

22 Oct 2026
Parliament mandate

Next
Trilogues · tied to the EU long-term budget

Procedure 2025/0222(COD) · Legislative Observatory, European Parliament

WHAT CARRIES OVER, WHATEVER THE TEXT

Prepare without betting on details

Horizontal priorities
inclusion first

Trusted partners

Results you can show

A track record as coordinator

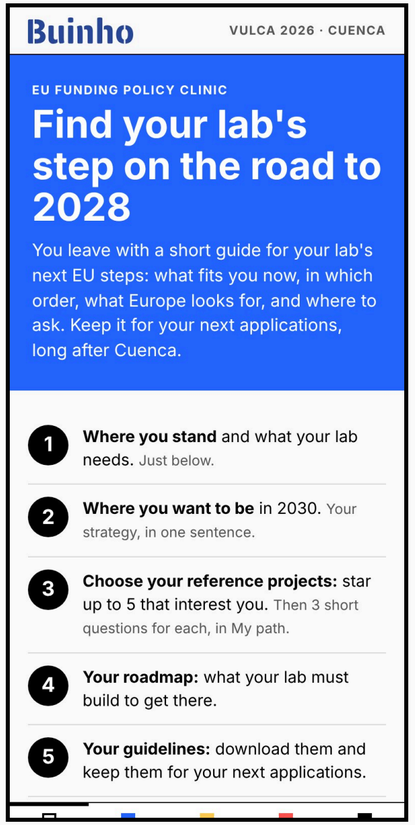
Same rules, different roads: start from your territory.

THE PLATFORM

From our arc to your road

28 **reference projects**

- 10 from Buinho, 18 from other European labs
- Checked on the Erasmus+ Project Results Platform
- Each with what it needed and where it sits in a strategy
- You leave with your own guide, as a PDF

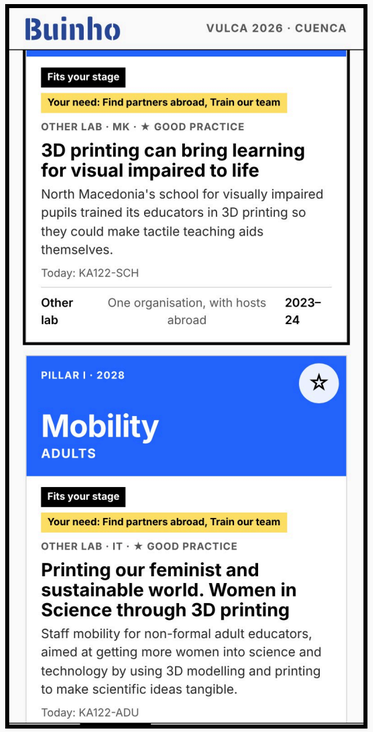


HOW IT WORKS

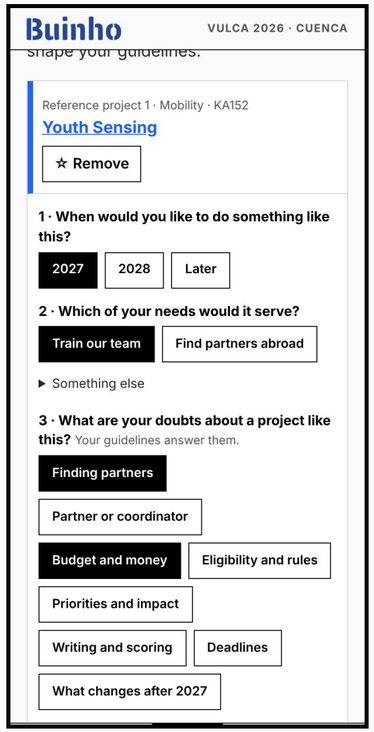
Five steps, on your phone



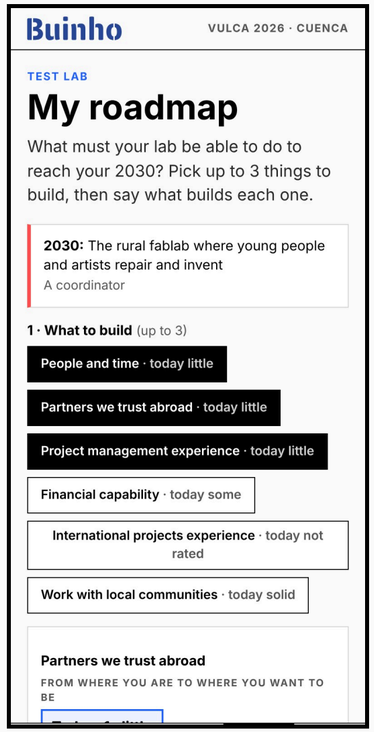
1 Start



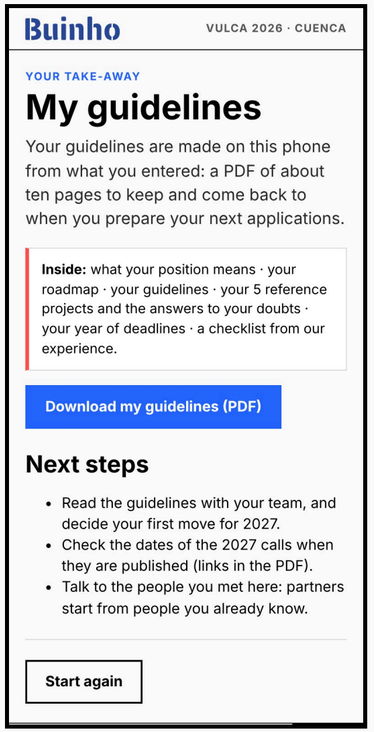
2 Projects



3 My path



4 Roadmap



5 My guide

STEPS 1–2

Say where you stand, then choose

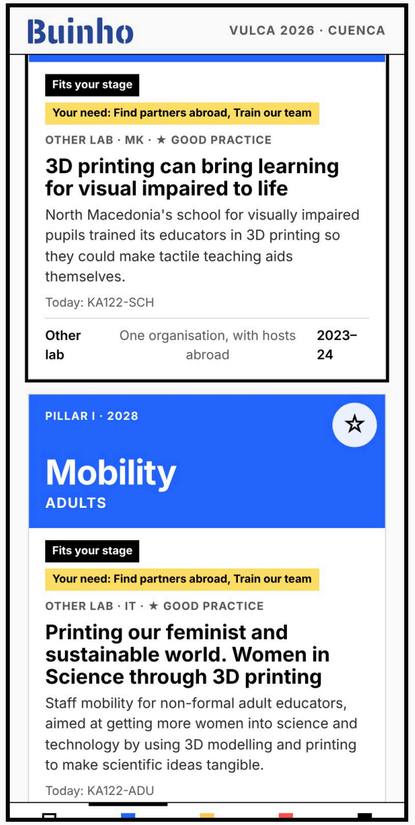
1 Experience: never applied, partner, coordinator

1 Six capacities, each from 1 to 3

1 Up to 3 needs · your lab in 2030 · your roles

2 Star up to 5 reference projects

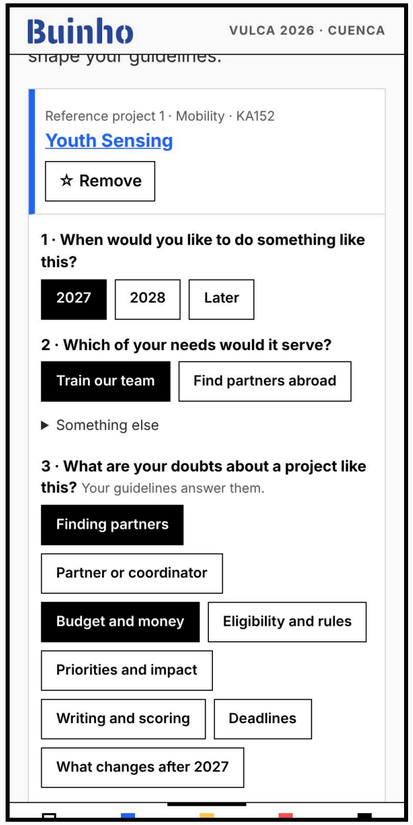


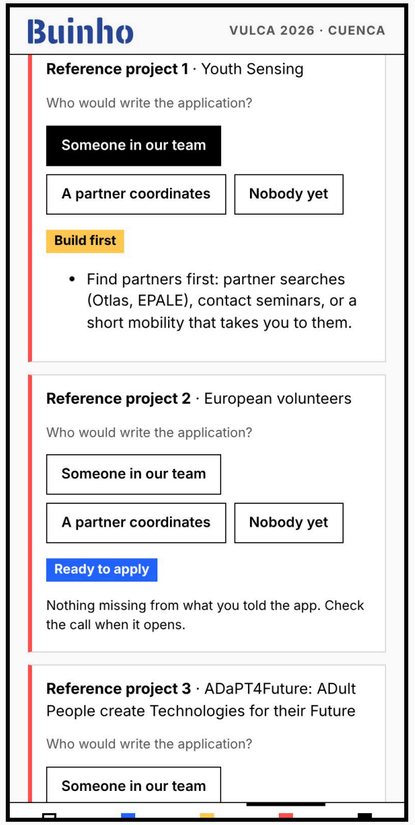


STEPS 3–4

Your path, then what to build

3	Up to 5 reference projects, 3 questions each
3	When · which need · your doubts about it
3	Any other question about EU funding
4	Up to 3 things to build, by when, and what builds them





STEP 5

Your guidelines, to keep

1 · WHERE YOU STAND

What your position means

Your answers on the start screen, read with our experience

YOUR EXPERIENCE WITH EU PROJECTS

You told us your lab has never applied. Look at the steps you chose with one question in mind: which of them can you do as a partner in someone else's project, or as a short mobility, before you carry the weight of coordinating?

WHAT YOU HAVE TODAY, AND WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT

People and time ● ○ ○ little	One person carrying the EU work alone is the most common bottleneck. Start where the admin is light: a short mobility (KA122), or join a project as partner, where the coordinator writes the application.
Partners we trust abroad ● ○ ○ little	Without partners you trust, coordinating is risky. Join other labs' projects first; use partner searches (Otlas, EPALE) and contact seminars; a job shadowing is a cheap way to test a partner.
Project management experience ● ○ ○ little	Start small to build a record: a short mobility (KA122) or a small-scale partnership (KA210), or be a partner and lead one clear part of a larger project.
Financial capability ● ● ○ some	Plan the cash gap between the start of a project and its final payment, and count any co-financing before you commit.
International projects experience ○ ○ ○	Not rated on the start screen.
Work with local communities ● ● ● solid	Your local roots are an asset: make them visible (the town hall as partner, open events, results used by the community).

WHAT YOU NEED MOST, AND WHICH REFERENCE PROJECT SERVES IT

Find partners abroad: European volunteers

Train our team: Youth Sensing

3 · YOUR GUIDELINES

Rules for your next initiatives

Drawn from your position, your 2030, your roadmap and your reference projects

1. **Say yes to a project only if it moves you towards your 2030.**
   "The rural fablab where young people and artists repair and invent" Projects that do not serve it cost the same work and leave less behind.
2. **Until 2027, build "Partners we trust abroad": from little to some.**
   Without partners you trust, coordinating is risky. Join other labs' projects first; use partner searches (Otlas, EPALE) and contact seminars; a job shadowing is a cheap way to test a partner. In your path: reference projects 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, Network or peer lab.
3. **Until 2028, build "People and time": from little to some.**
   One person carrying the EU work alone is the most common bottleneck. Start where the admin is light: a short mobility (KA122), or join a project as partner, where the coordinator writes the application. In your path: reference projects 1, 2, 4, 5, Volunteers, Town hall.
4. **Until 2028, build "Project management experience": from little to some.**
   Start small to build a record: a short mobility (KA122) or a small-scale partnership (KA210), or be a partner and lead one clear part of a larger project. In your path: reference projects 1, 3, 4, 5.
5. **Coordinate a small project before a large one.**
   Large partnerships and Creative Europe ask for a track record and financial capacity; a small-scale partnership builds both.
6. **Go only when: a partner you trust is on board three months before the deadline, someone has the time to write, and you can advance the costs.**
   In your path: before reference project 1, build partners we trust abroad; before reference project 3, build partners we trust abroad and project management experience.
7. **You start with mobility.**
   Good sequence: a mobility tests a method and lets you meet partners at low cost; the partnership that follows can be built on what you saw.
8. **Your path crosses programmes.**
   Make the link explicit: what does each step give the next one (people, method, partners, audience)? Evaluators reward continuity.
9. **Argue only for the priorities you select, and show them in the activities, the public and the results.**
   Inclusion is expected in almost every funded project: name who takes part and which barrier you lower. We found the opposite slip in our own forms, more than once.
10. **Prepare for 2028 without betting on details.**
    The new Erasmus+ (with the Solidarity Corps) and AgoraEU are still being negotiated. Trusted partners, results you can show and the horizontal priorities will count in any version.
11. **Review this roadmap with your team in November 2027.**
    By then the 2028 calls and the new Programme Guide should be known. Change the projects, keep the rules.

4 · YOUR REFERENCE PROJECTS

What each one means for your lab

What it would build, what it pays, and the answers to your doubts

1 · Youth Sensing — KA152 · 2027

READY?	Build first: Find partners first: partner searches (Otlas, EPALE), contact seminars, or a short mobility that takes you to them.
IT WOULD BUILD	Partners we trust abroad, People and time, Project management experience
YOUR NEEDS IT SERVES	Train our team
PRIORITIES IN ITS APPLICATION	Topics (the 2019 form had no priority field): Civic engagement / responsible citizenship · ICT, new technologies, digital competences · Access for disadvantaged
WHAT IT PAYS	Unit costs per participant and per day. Organisational support: €125 per participant (leaders and facilitators excluded). Why: running the exchange or the training.

YOUR DOUBTS, ANSWERED

BUDGET AND MONEY

Unit costs per participant and per day. Organisational support: €125 per participant (leaders and facilitators excluded). Why: running the exchange or the training. Travel: by distance, same bands as other mobility; green travel pays more.

FINDING PARTNERS

Look for track record you can check: search the organisation's name on the Erasmus+ Project Results Platform and see which projects it ran, with whom, and whether results are published or flagged as good practice. Most reliable partnerships start from people you already met: earlier projects, networks you are active in, partners of your partners, or seminars like this one.

2 · European volunteers — ESC · 2028

READY?	Ready to apply. Nothing missing from what you entered.
IT WOULD BUILD	Partners we trust abroad, People and time
YOUR NEEDS IT SERVES	Find partners abroad
PRIORITIES IN ITS APPLICATION	Volunteering project 2026, per activity: Inclusion and diversity · Environmental protection, sustainable development and climate action · Digital transition · Participation in democratic life
WHAT IT PAYS	Unit costs per volunteer and per day. The Quality Label itself carries no money: it is the door to apply. Organisational support: per volunteer per day, €27 in Portugal, €25 in Spain. Why: hosting, mentoring and supporting the volunteer.

YOUR DOUBTS, ANSWERED

PRIORITIES AND IMPACT

Erasmus+ has four horizontal priorities that apply to every action: inclusion and diversity; digital transformation; environment and fight against climate change; common values, civic engagement, preparedness and participation. Each field (schools, VET, adults, youth) adds its own specific priorities, and a partnership must address at least one, horizontal or of the field it affects most.

YOUR TURN · 25 MINUTES

Open the platform

ON YOUR PHONE OR LAPTOP

cuenca.buinho.pt

1
Go from Start to My guide

2
Ask me and the labs in the room

3
Download your guide (PDF)

EU projects — for which organisational strategy?

info@buinho.pt
buinho.pt

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Buinho Creative Hub · Messejana